



HOMEWORK 2: TARGET AUDIENCE

What is a Target Audience?

A Target Audience is the people you focus your primary marketing toward.

- **Doesn't mean you ignore other audiences.** Yes, you want everyone in your community to come to know and love Jesus. But if you don't focus you will reach no one. The majority of your energy should go toward the people you can impact, while you still value and serve all audiences.
- **Defines who your church can most effectively reach.** You want to reach as many people for Christ as possible, but your church may be more effective at reaching some people better than others or those that other churches are not reaching.
- **Tells you not only who you can reach but also what motivates them.** Their behaviors, preferences, likes/dislikes, what concerns them, what intrigues them.

How does identifying a Target Audience impact your MARKETING PLAN?

Identifying a target audience helps you speak their language. You will use words and messages that make sense to them and don't create barriers.

Example:

A church that targets people who have no church background will use words like outreach, service and friendship as opposed to evangelism, ministry and fellowship.

Identifying a target audience helps you point time and energy toward a specific group of people, thus making a greater impact.

Example:

A church targeting college students won't direct marketing toward retirees.

Knowing what motivates your audience will help you meet them where they are in order to introduce them to the love of Jesus.

Example:

A church targeting families with children will showcase the fun and friendship everyone can have at a church event. Once the family is at the event, the church uses tools and teaching that point them to Christ and faith.

Also consider the fact that while your Target Audience will be the people your marketing is directed toward, you will also need to communicate with a secondary audience ... the people you want to mobilize to share your marketing message (e.g., another need based group such as adults facing issues of taking care of kids and elderly family members)

Review/Respond



Review all of the summary reports that resulted from **Step 2: Perception & Need**. Write your thoughts about the questions below.

- What type of people do we most effectively reach?
- How do we reach those same types of people within our community?
- Who are the people not represented? Of those people, whose needs are we willing and able to address?

When thinking about the types of people we should target, describe some of their behaviors, likes, dislikes, barriers and how they would respond to your church.
